

## What is Social Advocacy?

Through a social media advocacy program, we are able to provide GitLab team members fresh news and updates about our organization and as well as throughout our industry. By having a tool in place that provides curated content, you'll be able to build your personal brand, become an expert in your topic, and contribute to the growth of GitLab.

Curators are selected intentionally by the Social Media team to drive our advocacy content strategy. You are responsible for curating stories to be shared by GitLab team members by adding content to the Bambu platform. Each piece of content added to Bambu should benefit your team or your topic. Please take the training and complete the issue you are assigned to. This will certify you as a curator in this program.

- Watch the training here

Watch the training here. You'll need to be logged into GitLab's Unfiltered YouTube account in order to access the video.

## What can I expect out of the training?

This training is conducted by a Strategic Services Consultant and provides a demonstration to help you navigate the platform, and understand the role of a curator. In this training, you will see the platform from a "reader" perspective, and curator's. This will help you learn the Bambu lifecycle. You will then learn how to set up a profile, connect your social media accounts, upload content to the platform, and view metrics.

This wasn't a live session, where can I ask remaining questions that I have?

Following the training, the social media team hosted an AMA so that curators could ask any remaining questions on the platform or the program. Questions and suggestions can still be submitted to the social-advocacy-curators Slack channel. This channel will also help you stay in touch with the curator program and the latest news. This channel is for team members who are identified as content curators only.

- Watch the AMA

Watch the AMA here. You'll need to be logged into GitLab's Unfiltered YouTube account in order to access the video.

</details>

## Current list of curators

|                                       |
|---------------------------------------|
| Name   Topic                          |
| -----   -----                         |
| TBD   Awards and contributed articles |
| Jessica Reeder   All Remote           |
| TBD   Open Source                     |

| Heather Simpson | Security |  
| Kira Aubrey | Field Marketing / PubSec |  
| Madison Taft | Sales |  
| TBD | Blogs (may cross into other topics as needed) |  
| Suri Patel | GitOps, Brand & Values |  
| Fiona O'Keefe | Customer Reference |  
| Jennifer Parker | Customer Reference |  
| Simon Lang | Internal Communications, Internal Stories |  
| TBD | Talent Brand, Job postings |  
| Wil Spillane | Admin/Manager, Brand & Values, News/Press |  
| Pj Metz | Education |

It's a curators responsibility to make sure that the content they want team members to share is SAFE

When drafting social posts for team members to share, curators should be sure to answer these questions:

- Does this material include any Sensitive or material nonpublic information?
- Is the information Accurate and verifiable?
- Does this information include Financial data, metrics, or predictions?
- Could sharing this information have a harmful Effect on our team members or the business?

Please be sure to review the SAFE Handbook page for detailed information.

Curator Checklist cheat sheet

When you add content into Bambu, consider the following:

- Ensure content is SAFE
- Organize with topic and tag
- Include contributor note as context for why the content is worth sharing and a short CTA:  
e.g. "This story helps to establish GitLabs all remote philosophy, share it with your communities."
- Include suggested social post copy
  - 1-2 versions for Twitter
  - 1-2 versions that cover both Facebook and LinkedIn
  - Diversify options: one copy for "professional" use (full words, no emoji, sounds clean and clear) and one copy for "fun" (emoji, exclamation points, light and fun).
- Add start and end date
  - Stories should be available for a minimum of 1 month from publishing (e.g, Sept 28th to Oct 28) however, consider your campaigns and communications focuses - big deal content could go on longer.

Recordings for Curators

Private videos, must be logged into the GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel to view

- Curator Kick off Sept 2021

## Topics in Bambu

Topics enable users in all roles to follow and unfollow collections of Stories grouped by an Admin. Admins can manage Topics inside the Topics tab in Company Settings.

- Admins can add Stories to up to two Required Topics that individuals cannot unfollow. For GitLab, we use Company News and Spotlight as the required topics that all team members will follow. This helps us to extend awareness of specific content we believe everyone should see and share.
- Up to three Topics can be applied to a Story.
- Topics can be measured inside Bambu's Content Report.
- When a new Topic is created, all individuals will automatically follow the Topic, unless it is restricted to a specific Team.
- All new users who register in Bambu will follow all Topics by default.
- Team Members will need to "unsubscribe" from topics that they wish to not see content about.

## Tags in Bambu

Tags operate as a reporting mechanism for GitLab. Tags help organize content and allow us to report on similar content in buckets. Tags in Bambu mirror tags in Sprout Social that the social team manages.

Some of these tags are as follows. More tags can be added as we see the need to report against other specifics.

- Video - for any content with a video link
- Campaign: - All Remote Brand anything related to remote content
- DevOps Platform - anything that discusses our DevOps Platform
- Case Study - any customer story
- Link - Owned - any time a link is shared that GitLab owns (our website, our blog, a GitLab Unfiltered video, user registration for an event, etc)
- Blog - any time we share a link to GitLab's blog
- Link - 3rd Party - any time we share a link that is not owned by GitLab (registration to an event that isn't GitLab's, links to press, partners, and other pages)
- Press - any media coverage
- Awards - any awards GitLab wins
- Campaign: Annual Dev Survey - related to this specific campaign
- Campaign: Remote Work Report - related to this specific campaign
- Campaign: GitLab Commit - related to this specific campaign/event

Tags can and should be combined. Examples:

- Sid was featured as a "top mind of the pandemic" by Forbes. When curating this article to Bambu, it should have the following tags: Link - 3rd Party, Press
- Cormac wrote a blog about GitLab's journey to becoming a DevOps Platform. When curating this article to Bambu, it should have the following tags: blog, Link - Owned, and DevOps Platform

## Formatting tips for curators

- Always find and use Twitter handles in the copy suggestions for Twitter.

- Never use any handles for copy suggestions for LinkedIn or Facebook, as they will not actually tag pages
- Never start a tweet with @. If you want to mention a handle first, add a ., so it would appear as .@GitLab. Without the period, Twitter will believe this is a response and not a broadcast, so the tweet will not appear on people's walls, dramatically reducing reach and making the post ineffective.
- When changing an image or story title, these changes will only appear on LinkedIn. The original title of the story and original image will appear on Facebook and Twitter.
- Regarding hashtags, when in doubt, leave it out. Platforms now focus on trends and topics without them. They can be helpful on LinkedIn, where users can follow a hashtag, but they are not required.
- When using hashtags, replace a word in the copy with a hashtag. Sometimes the tense and other elements don't allow this. Only then should you consider adding hashtags to the end of the copy suggestion.
  - E.g. MovingToGitLab: This works when we're using present tense in the copy, Company x is MovingToGitLab. This won't work if we're referencing a move from the past. Where we'd say, Company x migrated to GitLab and here's what they learned. MovingToGitLab
- Always add a CTA to the internal note: Consider sharing on social, please share on your channels, etc.
- Photo stories are not a priority and are only shareable on Facebook and Twitter, if we'd ever use these.

### Manager Tips

Managers in Bambu are able to add content freely without the social team's involvement. This requires strict adherence to the training and the details on this page. You want to make sure that all content is the best version to share and is ready when linked. Please always:

- Doublecheck that content is SAFE to share
- Confirm that you've made Twitter specific copy and used @handles or hashtags as needed on Twitter (do not try to tag on other channels)
- Share your new Bambu stories in Slack with the team who should share it most. PubSec share in your PubSec channels. All Remote, share in remote topic and whats-happening channels. Your stories need exposure to be shared, just be mindful that you don't want to flood Slack with the request.

Here's a copy suggestion when sharing in Slack.

text

We're promoting [this content] and would appreciate you sharing it on your social media! Check out the story in Bambu here and [post or schedule to post on social today].

(make the "post...today a link to the direct URL of the Bambu story).

Here's how to share the Bambu story link in Slack. (You'll need to be logged into GitLab Unfiltered YouTube)

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## SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/social-marketing/social-reporting.md

{{% alert color="info" %}}

Reporting on our brand's organic social media efforts is critical in determining if what we're doing is working and understanding our audiences better. This page outlines specifics on our reporting, including definitions of metrics.

{{% /alert %}}

## Dashboards and Reports

For GitLab Team Members only

| I'm looking for...                                                | ...this report or dashboard will help.       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
|                                                                   |                                              |
| -----                                                             | -----                                        |
|                                                                   |                                              |
| Sheet to enter raw performance data to social and data team only) | Raw metrics sheetload for Sisense (available |
| Ad equivalency dashboard for all social data and campaign         | Social Ad Equivalency Dashboard by objective |

## FY23 focuses

Check out the FY23 OKR Epic [here](#)

## Reporting changes in FY23

- Reordering metrics based on priority
  - Engagement, Engagement Rate, Clicks (most important 3 metrics)
  - then
  - Impressions, followers, and social ad value (least important metrics)
- Previously, CPC ad value was measured for owned links only. However, FY23 we've combined all links as one metric since all links are treated the same on social channels (they do not discriminate between owned and 3rd party links; performance is performance). We expect a creep up of value in reporting link click ad value
- Previously CPM was measured only on posts without a link. However, impressions are measured as impressions, and for FY23 we're counting all impressions, not just those that appeared on posts without a link (again, performance is performance). Expect increases in CPM ad value for FY23.

## Engagement

### Engagements

The number of times that users took action on our posts during the reporting period. This includes likes, retweets, comments, saves, replies, reactions, and shares. Does not include quote retweets. These actions are not weighed equally, and over time we'll be developing a unique and proprietary reporting method for engagements.

### Engagement Rate

The number of times during a reporting period that users engaged with our posts as a percentage of impressions. This metric indicates how engaging particular content or campaigns are overall. Engagement rate has been a pillar in social reporting for a decade, and is most closely tied to content quality.

Where does our data come from?

Our brand social team uses Sprout Social as our social media management software to schedule, engage, and report social media efforts. The majority of this data is already available natively across channels but is not curated or collated well for our purposes. Our single source of truth for all organic brand social data is Sprout Social.

Learn how we pull data from Sprout, add it to a sheetload, and get it into Sisense with this video (available to team members logged into our GitLab Unfiltered YouTube account only).

### Social Media Metric Definitions

Impressions are the number of times that our content was displayed to users. There are a few caveats:

- Twitter: This includes when other users retweet our posts.
- LinkedIn: This does not include when other users share our posts.
- Facebook: the number of times that any content associated with our page, not just a post (think updating images), was displayed to a user.
- Instagram: This does not include profile visitors.
- We use impressions = views, as defined for Corporate Marketing. This is not our most important metric for social-only performance but is one of the few metrics directly attributable to our shared top-of-funnel activity across teams.

Engagements are the number of times that users took action on our posts during the reporting period. This includes likes, retweets, comments, saves, replies, reactions, and shares. Does not include quote retweets.

Post Link Clicks (Link clicks or clicks for short) is the number of times that users clicked on links from your posts during the reporting period

Ad Value (or equivalency) is the GitLab-specific social media advertising dollar equivalent organized by post objective

- impressions (measured by CPM or Cost Per Thousand impressions)
- link clicks (measured by CPC or Cost Per Click)
- Ad Equivalency is a value-driven metric that is entirely determined by our real-world social advertising spend. We'll evaluate the ad equivalency per channel/quarter average.
- We present ad value as a dollar amount, determined by the sum of a reporting period's equivalent CPM + CPC costs

Net Follower Growth is the total number of new followers, less the amount of unfollows.

Follower Growth Rate is a percentage of growth over a reporting period. While we may look at this month-over-month, it's best-reviewed quarter-over-quarter or year-over-year.

Engagement Rate is the number of times during a reporting period that users engaged with our posts as a percentage of impressions. This metric indicates how engaging particular content or campaigns are overall.

## Reporting Cadences

Our cadences allow us regular reporting periods and the ability to be accountable to our team members in other groups or report performance regularly. The social team will not accommodate random reporting requests that were not previously required, agreed upon, or that the team feels inappropriate to use time or review the data.

Create an FY Reporting Epic and link to all reports here throughout the year

These epics can act as a living warehouse in GitLab to pull data from quarterly progress or campaign specific wrap up issues. The social team ought to add a link to these reporting issues to the FY Performance epic.

- FY22 Performance Epic

## Monthly Reporting

The social team will pull data for overall brand performance and select topics/campaigns before the end of the second week of the month following the reporting month (e.g., January data will be available before mid-February).

We will also add the necessary data to our Ad Equivalency dashboard in Google Sheets.

Workflow is as follows:

1. Open Sprout reports and configure for the month you're reporting for
1. Open Sheetload intake sheet in a separate window - either work side-by-side or use a second monitor.
1. Highlight all of the sections from the previous month in the Sheetload intake sheet. Copy these sections, then paste the entire series just below the last available dataset. You can now delete the month and the value sections, so that these can be updated to the month you're reporting for.
1. Pull data from Sprout. The best location of each data point is noted in the sourcedetails section of the Sheetload intake sheet
1. With the general brand numbers completed, you can move to the topics we report for each month. Head to the Topic Template tab of the Sheetload intake sheet. Highlight all data from column c rightward and copy.
1. Paste this blank data template into the Campaign and Topic Reporting tab of the Sheetload intake sheet, from column c rightward. This will act as the intake for one of the topics/campaigns we report on. Select one of the Topic/Sprout Tag items to use and complete all of the data by heading to the Tag Performance Report in Sprout and selecting the appropriate tag.
1. Redo step 6 for each of the reporting campaigns/topics. Currently 3: Campaign: All Remote Brand, Tag: Press Coverage, Tag: Blog Shares

## Quarterly Reporting

When the social team adds the third month of data from a quarter to the ad equivalency dashboard, we'll include the average CPC and CPM by social channel, closing the metrics for the quarter. Note, ad value performance won't be available until after the quarter closes.

We'll wrap each quarter with an issue outlining performance and insights. Please use the social-quarterly-report issue template. Here's what a completed issue on quarterly performance looks like.

## Annual Reporting

FY22 Performance Review Deck

FY21 Performance Review Deck

Annual reports should encompass all consumption methods: Epics, issues, written summaries, a deck, and a recording of the deck with the social team reviewing.

Use the FY21 epic and issue outline to build the FY22 versions.

Annual reporting should be communicated to campaign/topic stakeholders, the communications and corporate marketing team, and the marketing organization overall. Include as updates in the marketing Slack channel.

## Reporting, Data, and User Behavior Limitations

With social media data, there will always be a set of limitations based on what metrics are available, how each channel defines them, how our tools collate the data, and whether or not other variables are in play.

- We can't currently combine Sprout tags to review overall performance (e.g., if we wanted to check out how a specific campaign performs, but to compare how owned links performed vs. no link posts, would require manual math). This is universal across our Sprout instance due to the mechanisms inside Sprout.
- Posts can only count towards one ad equivalency metric. A post is either for brand awareness and engagement on social channels or to generate clicks to a website. Because of this, we can qualify the ROI of a post according to the specific type of ad equivalency, but never more than one kind.
- Ad equivalency is not a 1:1 of what GitLab would have needed to pay as a part of social advertising. Posts written as ads are dramatically different than those crafted for organic social media. Specific targeting available in social advertising will also impact an ad's performance. So we must look at ad equivalency as a proxy for spending -- we're adding value, not eliminating ad budget.
- Ad equivalencies are not a metric we measure for growth. As GitLab's social media advertising becomes more efficient over time, the cost will decrease. As our social advertising costs decrease, each action's value for impressions or clicks that the ads are optimized for becomes cheaper to purchase. So, organic social media ad equivalency should reduce as our social advertising becomes more effective. We measure the ad equivalency as added value.
- Many of the core metrics that the social team reports on have inverse relationships. Posts with higher impressions tend to have lower clicks (and the opposite is true as well). A post shared worldwide and has a high volume of engagements may have a low engagement rate, mainly if



the impressions are high. There are other inverse relationships across other metrics. When crafting posts, the social team considers the one action we'd like users to take, and we try to organize the copy, assets, time, and channel to be in our favor.

## Reporting Tips

- To review a specific metric per campaign/tag in Sprout, export all posts as a csv file, upload the csv file to Sheets, and then filter posts tagged with the tag we want to report by. This is not an equally weighted review across channels, however it does work to provide channel-specific reporting.

## Sprout Tags

Tag use in Sprout is the core mechanism we use to develop reports on social media performance. This is why it's important to consider using all tags that might be appropriate to use, for every post scheduled. Below, you'll find details on some of our most used tags and tips for using them effectively.

{{% alert color="success" %}}

All tags, except campaign tags, can be used together and often should be included together.

This means you may be using more than one pillar or type tag.

{{% /alert %}}

## Sprout tag use examples

- Promoting REMOTE event with a highlight video and registration link
  - use: Pillar: All Remote, Type: Link, Type: Video, Campaign: REMOTE event
- Promoting a general new blog about how it's like to work at GitLab
  - use: Pillar: Blogs, Pillar: Talent Brand, Type: Link
- Promoting a Twitter Spaces Q&A with a speaker from Commit, the topic is DevOps Leadership
  - use: Pillar: Corporate Events, Pillar: DevOps, Type: Audio, Campaign: Commit

## Content Pillar Tags

Content Pillar Tags allow the social team to tag the most common identifying item among our posts, the overall purpose or focus of the post. Most pillar tags are associated with other teams the social marketing team works with, as these are the easiest identifiers to connect on. Pillar tags allow us to develop reports for top level focuses to show long term performance at the highest level.

{{% alert color="success" %}}

These tags are stackable, they can be combined.

{{% /alert %}}

- · Pillar: All Remote
  - when scheduling any content about GitLab's all remote brand
- · Pillar: Blogs
  - when scheduling any content from the blog
- · Pillar: Community
  - when scheduling any content associated with the community team

- · Pillar: Corporate Events
    - when scheduling any content related to the corporate events team
  - · Pillar: DevOps
    - when scheduling any content about DevOps as a topic, it does not need to be about GitLab.
- Thought leadership.
- · Pillar: Press / News
    - when scheduling any content related to the corporate comms team, or comes from PR agencies
  - · Pillar: Product
    - when scheduling any content directly related to GitLab's product offering
  - · Pillar: Talent Brand
    - when scheduling any content related to talent / employer brand efforts

## Content Type Tags

Content Type Tags allow the social team to measure performance by formats. This is important for us to measure how engaging individual types of content are, as well as, whether or not we'd hit other goals.

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{{% alert color="success" %}}
```

These tags are stackable, they can be combined.

```
{{% /alert %}}
```

- · Type: Audio
  - when scheduling content that contains audio only files, like Twitter Spaces
- · Type: Case Studies
  - when scheduling content that has links to, or contains details from, GitLab case studies.

If Sharing case study link, also include the Type: Link tag.
- · Type: Link
  - when scheduling any content we add a link to, whether or not it includes a social card, an image instead of a card, or if the link is to a GitLab or 3rd party destination.
- · Type: Photo
  - when scheduling content with a photo asset attached.
- · Type: Poll
  - when scheduling content that uses the poll feature on a social channel. Not to be confused with questions, this is when there is a shortlist of preselected options for users to choose from.
- · Type: Question
  - when scheduling content that includes an open-ended question for users to answer as they please. Not to be confused with polls, where there are pre-determined options for users to choose from
- · Type: Video
  - when scheduling content that includes native video or links to a video assets elsewhere. If linking to a video asset elsewhere, include the Type: Link tag as well

## Campaigns

Campaign tag types appear differently in Slack. They have their own section to select a tag when scheduling content. You can also build a social campaign from start to finish using the Campaign Planner feature, which includes timelines, a brief form, and other details. Campaign tags are used based on the campaigns we work on at GitLab and allow for more granular

reporting. Rather than relying on performance for all remote content overall, we can target specific events (like REMOTE) or marketing campaigns (like the Remote Work Report).

{{% alert color="danger" %}}

Campaign tags are not stackable, they cannot be combined. Since only one campaign tag can be used for posts, it's important to keep communication objectives for the post clear and include only one campaign.

{{% /alert %}}

Some existing tags we may use throughout the year are identified below, but new campaign tags will be created according to the campaigns we work on through the year.

- · Commit
- · Kubecon
- · GitLab 15
- · REMOTE by GitLab
- · Remote Playbook
- · DevSecOps Survey
- · AWS reInvent
- · others not identified here

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## SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/social-marketing/team-member-social-advocacy.md

Login to EveryoneSocial via Okta SSO (link tbd)

### Team Member Social Media Advocacy and Enablement

Team member advocacy is the promotion of an organization by its staff members. People trust recommendations and content from people they know. They trust these people a lot more than they trust marketing messages from companies on organic brand social channels or paid social media advertising. We know this when a team member can post the same content the brand channel publishes, but because the message was more personal, more human, the team member gains significant engagement over the brand channel.

### Social Advocacy Strategy

To enable all GitLab team members to confidently and comfortably share GitLab related stories on their personal social media channels in a way that is risk averse yet provides measureable performance.

### Goals of social media advocacy

- Improve the organic reach of GitLab messaging
- Increase traffic to our site from social media, particularly to blogs and campaign content
- Reduce brand and team member risk by providing curated content to publish
- Secondary: aid in sales processes for social selling initiatives
- Secondary: drive recruitment to accelerate hiring values-drive team members

## Benefits of social advocacy to all team members

- Curated and prewritten drafts for social posts allow for easy publishing with minimal edits required
- Posts can be scheduled, like a social media manager would for the brand, allowing the work to be semi-automated
- Easy way to include incentives like swag, bonuses, or other add-ons
- Career growth: sharing industry content on social media can help make team members be looked at as thought leaders in their spaces - this boosts your personal brand
- Save time - by checking Bambu on a regular cadence and scheduling content on your channels for a week or two, you'll be enabled to share a lot of GitLab stories without the need to spend a lot of time sourcing, writing, and manually posting on your own social channels

## EveryoneSocial, our social advocacy tool

EveryoneSocial is an employee advocacy platform for you to share content across LinkedIn, Twitter/X, Instagram or Facebook. EveryoneSocial enables you to quickly and easily share content on social media platforms to amplify our brand reach and help establish your personal brand on social media. The goal of this tool is to centralize content that is valuable to our audience.

<details><summary>How do I get started?</summary>

<p>

First, you'll need to confirm that you have been assigned the EveryoneSocial application in Okta in order to use it. If you are not assigned EveryoneSocial in Okta and you are interested, please reach out to the team in the socialmediaaction Slack channel.

</p>

<p>

You'll need to log into Okta and locate the EveryoneSocial logo tile. Click on the Okta tile.

IF you haven't made an account yet, you'll be prompted to do so. You'll always have access to EveryoneSocial via logging in with Okta.

</p>

<p>

Click the login with SSO option at the bottom of the page to log in whenever you want.

</p>

</details>

<details><summary>What am I supposed to do inside Bambu?</summary>

<p>

When you log into EveryoneSocial, you will see a collection of stories curated specifically for you.

</p>

<p>

This is a centralized hub for you to learn, build your reputation online, and help spread the word about GitLab by sharing these stories with your networks on social media. We made it easy to share, too.

</p>

<p>

When you click the share icon on any story, you'll see that we've added a suggested status update. Of course, you're welcome to adjust or completely rewrite it to match your own voice (the only exception to this will be when you're sharing content that needs to be worded a certain way for compliance reasons, in which case, we'll say so in the notes).

</details>

<details><summary>How often am I supposed to login to EveryoneSocial?</summary>

<p>

As often as you like, but try to make a habit of logging in at least once a week, as we are constantly adding new and useful information.

</p>

<p>

We will make sure that any time-sensitive stories find their way to you through Slack, like in the whats-happening-at-gitlab channel.

</p>

<p>

There are other ways to stay in touch with the latest stories to share:

</p>

<p>

<a href="https://slack.com/blog/productivity/make-it-a-habit-periodic-reminders-for-slack">Create a recurring Slack reminder</a> to check EveryoneSocial once a week or every other week.

</p>

<p>

If you run your workday via your calendar, consider adding a 25 min block once a week or every other week to login and share the latest stories

</p>

</details>

<details><summary>Can I automate EveryoneSocial?</summary>

<p>

TBD

</p>

</details>

Team Member Roles in EveryoneSocial the advocacy program

<details><summary>Admins</summary>

<p>

The GitLab Social Team are the administrators of the social advocacy program. Admins have all access to our tool, BEveryoneSocial , as needed to operate the program. Admins may act as

curators from time to time as well.

</p>

<p>

If you have questions or would like to learn more, consider sending a message in the socialmediaaction Slack channel.

</p>

</details>

<details><summary>Curators (or Contributors)</summary>

<p>

Curators are selected intentionally to drive our advocacy content strategy and specific team members are asked to take on the role of a curator as a part of their everyday jobs at GitLab. We will have curators representing all areas of GitLab the brand and the product in order to curate a list of related content worth sharing on social media.

</p>

<p>

Curators have all Reader access as well as the ability to curate stories and submit them to a Manager or Admin for approval.

</p>

<p>

Join the social-advocacy-curators Slack channel to stay in touch with the curator program and the latest news. This channel is intended for team members who are identified as content curators only.

</p>

<p>

<a href="https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/social-marketing/social-advocacy-curators/">If you're a curator or interested in becoming a curator, head to our curator-specific handbook page here.</a>

</p>

</details>

<details><summary>General Team Members (or Readers)</summary>

<p>

All team members can access the Stories feed, share to their social networks and leverage the Suggestions feature to submit links to a Manager or Admin for complete Story curation.

</p>

<p>

Access to EveryoneSocial is provided via an Okta tile - please log in to Okta and find the EveryoneSocial logo tile to Log on.

</p>

<p>

Join the social-advocacy Slack channel to stay in touch with the program and the latest news.

</p>

</details>

Suggesting content for team members to share on EveryoneSocial

## TO BE UPDATED

While we have a team of content curators working to add relevant and fresh content for the whole team to share on a regular basis, you may come across content that you'd like us to consider adding to EveryoneSocial, mainly content from 3rd party sources: your own blogs or a partner website link. Here's how to suggest content to an admin to add to EveryoneSocial.

- Click the +Suggest Story button in the upper right hand corner
- Paste the story URL and click Suggest Story
- The admin team will review your suggestion. If we approve it, we'll mark you as the curator for the content.

Please note that most of what is appropriate to share that comes from GitLab will be curated already.

## Become an EveryoneSocial Power User with Scheduling Content

Elevate the way they use EveryoneSocial, and in turn produce more content shares, engagement and overall content impact. You can become a power user in less than 15 minutes a day!

### Schedule a post at least every other day

We certainly don't want you to share just for the sake of sharing, but with EveryoneSocial, you'll have relevant content curated for you almost daily. By sharing more often, it signals to your social audience that you are a go-to source of information and expertise.

Schedule content in advance using the content scheduler function in EveryoneSocial. Consider scheduling posts during your timezones regular business hours --- at the start of the work day (7am - 10am) around lunch time (11am - 1pm) and just after the end of the day (5pm - 7 pm). What works for your followers may also be different - it's important to check out post performance and to try out different times to see which would work best.

Scheduling stories on your social media channels is the best way to automate some of the manual work behind promoting content on social media. While it still requires you to check out Bambu and to edit the copy suggestions, you can "set it and forget it" and bulk a week or two worth of social posts in one short period of time. This is how the scheduling feature looks in Bambu.

### Customize the post copy with your point of view

EveryoneSocial let's us include suggested post copy for you, but to truly stand out and resonate with your audience, customize the suggested post copy to reflect your perspective on the content you're sharing. Make sure to incorporate best practices like hashtags, tagging handles and others outlined in our social advocacy handbook. And remember, it's required to change 20 characters of the copy for Tweets, so have some fun with it.

Pro tip: If you're stuck on what to say, think "how would I explain this content to someone if I was talking to them in person?" and use your answer as the basis for your copy. People react well to posts that sound like a human.

### Engage beyond the share

When your audience really connects with a post you've shared, they may comment with their thoughts or even a question. It's a great opportunity to start a dialogue by replying to their comment and sharing more of your perspective.

Pro tip: Aim to reply to comments within 1-2 days to keep the conversation timely and relevant.

## Integrations

- We are actively working to integrate into Salesforce and Slack.

## Slack and EveryoneSocial (TBC)

The Slack integration (WIP) will allow us to broadcast an EveryoneSocial story link to Slack, giving our team the heads up on big news items that we'd like to share.

You can also check out the latest stories on Everyone Social inside of any Slack channel by using TBD for a private message showing you our top stories.

## Okta

Onboarding: Access to EveryoneSocial is provisioned via Okta. Team members are automatically assigned EveryoneSocial during the Okta onboarding process and are informed of the tool after the first week in the onboarding issue.

Offboarding: When a team member loses access to Okta, they will also lose access to EveryoneSocial. This provides an automatic way to revoke access to former team members.

## Reporting and Metrics

Conversion Rate - the percentage of team members invited to the program that are actually participating

Active Participation - the percentage of team members that are engaged in the program and sharing on any given reporting period (week/month/quarter)

Top Contributors identifying top contributors helps to understand the kind of content that will work best and recognizing top contributors is a good way to keep the program engaging

Organic reach - the number of people seeing content shared through Bambu by our team member advocates

Engagement - measuring the number of actions taken on content shared through Bamby by our team member advocates (think likes, clicks, comments, and shares)

Ad value or equivalency - similar to how we measure this for the brand, this is measured in a dollar value for advertising determined by the sum of a reporting period's equivalent CPM + CPC costs

## EveryoneSocial FAQs

Will EveryoneSocial replace the use of issues for social media enablement for team members?



Yes, that was a part of the original goal. Using GitLab issues for social enablement is an extremely manual process that has not been efficient. EveryoneSocial will allow a centralized and easy to use administration to the entire company while also helping us to understand performance metrics.

What personally identifiable data is available for GitLab?

GitLab is not given any personal information about your social media profiles, actions, comments, DM, or any other element. When you connect your social media channels to Bambu it provides a way for you to schedule and publish content on your social channels automatically using all of the APIs available on these social channels. It also provides a top level, no context review of performance metrics on posts you published on your personal social media channels through Bambu only.

The data that GitLab receives shows your posts published through EveryoneSocial:

- Reach - or how many people saw the posts you published through EveryoneSocial
- Engagements - or how many actions people took on the posts you published through EveryoneSocial; comments, likes, shares, etc.
- Clicks - or how many times people clicked on the link you published in your post through EveryoneSocial

GitLab cannot see who liked your posts, what their comments were on your posts, who shared your posts, or any information relating to posts that are not published through Bambu (so all of your personal activity is still personal).

Here is a look at the data that is personally identified with individual team members. Note again that we cannot see the context behind the data and this is only for content that is scheduled and published through EveryoneSocial.

Why are preview images, titles, and text not included within shared posts?

There may be an issue with the page you're trying to use for the story. Preview images, titles, and text are dictated by the data in the frontmatter of the page, and we may not have control over what appears here. Learn more about how to determine what information gets pulled by social channels [here](#).

Can I share content that is not already in Bambu through Bambu for better reporting?

No, we do not have this feature activated and it is not on our roadmap.

Can I suggest individual pieces of content be added to Bambu?

Yes, there is a suggestion feature built into the tool. You'll see a Suggest Story button on the top left of your screen. However, we have an active group of curators who are responsible for curating content. We are asking that the team keep their suggestions away from topics that are already accounted for with DRIs. Please connect with the DRI for a topic if you believe a piece of content should be added, since they are the responsible party on their assigned topic. Applying a team member's suggestion is entirely at the discretion of the social team and/or the assigned DRI for a specific topic and is subjective to what else is being

promoted, if there are more important pieces of content for that topic, etc.

Please keep in mind that providing a suggestion is only the first piece of the work necessary for the content to appear for the entire team to share on Bambu. We'd still need to vet the content for standards, legal review, write copy for the posts, and release it to be available in the platform. Adding suggestions adds more work for the social team and our team of curators, so make it worth it!

Is EveryoneSocial connected to Salesforce?

We are actively integrating with Salesforce. This integration allows you the convenience of staying in Salesforce and still being able to view and share content to your social channels.

Where does the content in EveryoneSocial come from?

The content in EveryoneSocial comes from a group of GitLab team members we call curators, they help us to source and promote content that is important in their line of work. Folks from the security team will provide security related content, our all remote team will provide content about remote work, and so on. If there is a focus that is not being represented and it would provide content that the team actually wants to promote, please reach out in social-advocacy-curators Slack channel with your idea. Please note that in the first few months of this program launch, we are not prioritizing more topics and more curators, so while the idea might be great, we'll need to add any additional thoughts to a future iteration. Learn more about our curator program.

I don't see anything about [your topic of choice] in EveryoneSocial, why is that?

This could be for a number of reasons. If the topic is already covered in EveryoneSocial, the DRI may not have gotten to review this content yet or may have deemed other pieces more important to include. If the topic is not already covered in Bambu, this would be why it's not on the platform. At this point, we could discuss it further if you reach out in social-advocacy-curators Slack channel with your idea. Please note that in the first few months of this program launch, we are not prioritizing more topics and more curators, so while the idea might be great, we'll need to add any additional thoughts to a future iteration. Learn more about our curator program.

What's in the next iteration of EveryoneSocial and social advocacy?

Sales: We're interested in getting our sales team and their sales-adjacent partners access to content that will help them drive better results as well as plug into the tools they use, like Salesforce.

Talent Brand: We'd like to work with the talent acquisition and talent brand teams to curate more employer brand content that could lend in securing better talent in our pipeline.

If you are in one of these teams and would like to volunteer your time to build these iterations out, please reach out to the social team in the social-advocacy-curators Slack channel.

Best Practices

Here are some best practices for using Bambu for GitLab-related social media posts.

### Use Your Voice

- Write posts in your own personal voice and style.
- Be sure to refer to GitLab with "we" and not "I" (as appropriate) to represent the company and the community. Remember that even if you are not a formal spokesperson for the company, people will see you as a representative of GitLab.
- If you choose to address competitors, highlight positive differences (focus on the ways that GitLab outperforms other solutions)
- For example, if someone complains about GitLab's product, you can suggest they'd tell us more by providing feedback in the issue tracker. Someone thinks GitLab could be better? Invite them to submit a feature proposal.

### Social Media Structure and Style

Make sure your copy follows the AIDA Model, a copywriting formula to drive interest and action from your audience.

- Attention: Catch your audience's attention to create awareness.
- Interest: Drive interest by connecting with your reader.
- Desire: Generate desire by explaining what they get out of it.
- Action: Move your reader to take action. (ex. 'Learn more')
- Try to visually break it into paragraphs or one-liners (even using emoji/bullets) for longer copy. For example:

text

GitLab has been a catalyst for change when it comes to the evolution of DevSecOps.

That's why we were recognized as a challenger in the 2021 Gartner Magic Magic Quadrant for Application Security Testing! ·

Learn more about this award. ·

### Ideal post length

- X/Twitter: 70 to 100 characters
- LinkedIn: around 100 characters
- Facebook: around 100 characters

You can always go longer or use threaded tweets, but this is a good recommendation based on the top performing posts across these channels.

### Addressing and Avoiding Conflict

Feel free to disagree with people. Try to inform the person (respectfully) and provide any links they may need to make a more informed decision. Begin your response with "I disagree" as opposed to "You're wrong."

Sometimes, the best course of action is to walk away and not engage with the person at all. Use your judgment in how you approach rude or off-putting comments from strangers in real life to help you decide.

You can choose not to engage with arguments, step away from the conversation and delegate to someone else, or give a simple acknowledgment (e.g. "Thanks for sharing your opinion.")

For a foundational understanding of these nuances, read GitLab's guide to communicating effectively and responsibly through text.

- Assume good faith. People have opinions and sometimes they're strong ones. It's usually not personal.
- Sometimes all people need is acknowledgment. Saying "Sorry things aren't working for you" can go a long way.

If you are unsure if you should respond to someone who has responded to your posts, join the [socialmediaaction](#) Slack channel and ask for feedback.

### Promote your public-facing work

If you've written a blog for our site, contributed to our latest release, or joined a webinar/webcast, you should want to tell your networks about it. Not only does this provide a way to build your following and expertise in the public domain, but it's also a great way to add critical promotion to your work. Promoting on social media isn't just about the GitLab brand channels. It's an orchestra of efforts, which includes team member support and advocacy.

### Profile assets (to be updated)

Profile assets for social media can be found in the corporate marketing repository

Please do not use the GitLab logo as the avatar for your accounts on social. You are welcome to use our branded banners, but your profile avatar mustn't lead users to confuse your account with the official GitLab accounts.

While you should display the fact that you work at GitLab in your bio if you intend to advocate for GitLab on social, we suggest that you avoid including the word GitLab in your handle. Team member advocacy is incredibly valuable, and we are lucky to have so many engaged team members, but creating an account to solely post about GitLab is not adequate. Team member advocacy is so powerful that people trust employees more than brands and executives. Your advocacy is powerful when it is authentic, and having an account that only exists to promote GitLab will not ring true to others who browse your tweets.

### Tips FAQ

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Am I required to share/like a post from GitLab social channels?

</summary>

<i>No, you're not required to participate in any way.</i>

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Am I required to have the social or comms team review my posts before I publish them?

</summary>

<i>No, the GitLab social team will never require a review or another oversight of your own personal social media posts. If you are using suggestions from Bambu or another tool or issue we've provided, the copy is already written to be public-facing.</i>

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Am I required to identify myself as a GitLab employee on my social media channel?

</summary>

<ul>

<li><i>No, you are not required to identify yourself as an employee for simply having a personal channel. However, if you are going to engage with community members or be considered an authority in your space, you ought to be transparent and identify yourself as a team member.</i></li>

<li><i>If you talk about work-related matters within your job responsibility area, you must disclose your affiliation with GitLab. If you have a vested interest in something you're posting on social, point it out. You can identify yourself as a team member in your profile bio, list GitLab as your employer, or mention that you're a team member in the post itself. Consider adding LifeAtGitLab to the end of your social post to sum it up quickly and easily.</i></li>

</ul>

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

I don't want to write my own posts. I'd rather share GitLab's social posts. Is there an easy way to know when they are published?

</summary>

<i>We use a program named Bambu to help you write social posts and share online. You may already have access via Okta. If you do not have access, please reach out to the social-advocacy Slack channel to gain access.</i>

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

I don't know how to respond to a comment someone posted to me. How can I find help?

</summary>

<i>Consider joining the social-advocacy Slack channel for an easy way to connect with the social team for help.</i>

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

What should I do if a friend/follower/user responds to me about controversies?

</summary>

<i>Consider not engaging with that person and ignoring their comments. The probability of "Twitter arguments" around various crises and controversies is high and it is recommended that you don't fall into a fight with someone on the internet.</i>

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Where can I learn more about social media for our company?

</summary>

<i>You can check out our social media handbook here.</i>

</details>

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## SECTION: marketing/lifecycle-marketing/\_index.md

## Lifecycle Marketing

### Overview

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Lifecycle Marketing is responsible for strategizing, executing, and optimizing a data-driven user lifecycle communications strategy and overall email marketing plan, including ongoing nurture email campaigns.

This role works closely across Marketing for all things email, and directly with the Product Growth, Data, and Self-service Teams to collaborate, plan, and prioritize communication to better engage GitLab users and progress them through the buyer and customer lifecycle. The lifecycle marketing manager will focus on user paths to revenue, including engaging free .com users, trial users, and paid users of GitLab.

Read the job family here >>

For more information on email marketing at GitLab, please visit the following pages:

Nurture programs

Best practices,

Email processes and requests

Please reach out to Allie Klatzkin or Alison Lee with any questions.

Meet the Team

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Allie Klatzkin Manager and Team Lead, Lifecycle Marketing

Buyer / User Persona Nurture: DRI for organization of new content additions to the intelligent nurture, build of new streams within the nurture architecture in collaboration with marketing operations

Action Streams: Develop and build lifecycle's strategy for interest based action streams

GitLab Ultimate + Duo Enterprise Trial User Campaigns: DRI for trial nurture, focused on progressing trial users to paid

Calendar and stakeholder conversations (DRI): Lead weekly email calendar conversations to ensure we are prioritizing our email sends per audience

Email Templates: define needs, organize design, and manage development and testing of new email templates

Email Best Practices, Processes & Optimization: enable teams across GitLab (mainly Marketing and Sales Dev) on email best practices, as well as streamlining, scaling, and improving email performance

GitLab Corporate Events: Global templates and scaling process for promoting and following up from corporate events and conferences.

Email point of contact/support: Reviewing and optimizing AMER & Global events (fmm & corp), campaigns, and newsletter email sends to ensure best practices and compliance with the GitLab brand

Localization: Owning the translation and localization strategy for email, building new nurtures for prospects

PubSec Nurture: Rebuild the nurture to educate leads on the value of GitLab for the Public Sector and ultimately generate MQLs

Alison Lee Senior Customer Lifecycle Marketing Manager

Customer upsell / cross sell / retention

Create and continuously optimize email marketing programs that leverage 3rd party signals (e.g. firmographic or demographic) as well as customer behavior data to drive revenue growth or prevent churn

Partner with Customer Success to coordinate marketing and support touchpoints for maximum revenue impact

Partner with Marketing Analytics to define customer lifecycle reporting and create dashboards to analyze tests, monitor performance against goals

Map GitLab's customer lifecycle stages and create strategic initiatives for each stage of the customer journey, which include onboarding, expansion, and retention

Identify key measurable metrics (SKU upsell, license expansion, churn prevention, etc.) that these lifecycle programs can effectively influence

Build and maintain relationships with Product Marketing, Developer Relations, and Sales.

Establish feedback loops to ensure messaging in our campaigns is accurate, differentiated, and meaningful to our target personas

Free User Campaigns: DRI for free user efficiency project, focused on progression of free users to trial to paid

Duo Pro & Duo Enterprise Campaigns: DRI for email campaigns related to our AI product

Re-engagement nurture: Develop and implement strategy for re-engagement email nurture

Email point of contact/support: Reviewing and optimizing AMER & APAC events (fmm) and campaigns sends to ensure best practices and compliance with the GitLab brand

## Christian Baun Lifecycle Marketing Manager

Manage updates/optimizations to our existing Persona nurture and PubSec nurtures

Support localized nurture programs for prospects

Own MM+ transformation of trial nurture: Pivot self-serve to focus on business trials: optimize for high-value biz trials and reduce wasted spend on low-ROI trials starts with personal emails.

Ongoing maintenance/optimization of global prospect campaigns post launch (recycled leads nurture, industry nurtures)

Regional/event email reviews for EMEA/APAC

Email Templates: manage development and testing of new and existing email templates

### Communication

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

In line with GitLab's overall communication guidelines, lifecycle marketing managers work through MRs first and issues second (in order to preserve documentation), and our slack channel lifecycle-marketing is used for team updated and quick questions.

The marketingintegratedmarketing channel is used for weekly check-ins and interaction with the larger integrated marketing team.

In between bi-weekly Lifecycle Marketing Team calls:

Updates should be added to MRs when possible

Add to lifecycle-marketing Slack

Begin with UPDATE: <brief description> (i.e. UPDATE: Marketo segmentation live for sales segment)

Include link to MR (preferred) or issue

Topics that need input should be added as an MR when possible, with issues as a secondary option, and pinged in Slack with DISCUSS

Add to lifecycle-marketing Slack

Begin with DISCUSS: <brief description> (i.e. DISCUSS: Marketing tool champions)

Include link to MR (preferred) or issue

### Meeting Cadence

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Bi-weekly - Lifecycle Marketing Team sync (lifecycle marketing)

Weekly - Email Stakeholder call

Bi-weekly - Digital Strategy sync

Bi-weekly - Integrated Marketing sync

Monthly - Marketing All-Hands (all marketing)

### The Handbook

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Is our single source of truth (SSoT) for processes and relevant links

Individual teams should link back to these SSoT sections to avoid confusion



Collaborative tactics contain their own handbook pages

The handbook will be iterated on as we establish and optimize processes for optimal efficiency

Project Management

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Prioritization

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

#### 1. Lifecycle Marketing - Prioritization

At start of milestone, ensure that issues are in the proper category of prioritization.

Align them to the priority definitions.

Consider the time you have available in a 2 week period, recognizing meeting commitments and planned PTO.

Only add issues to account for 70% of your available work hours. Don't max out at 100% since there will likely be things that arise and need immediate attention throughout milestone.

Ask yourself: considering realistic time this milestone, am I overcommitting? The first to drop from a milestone should be "Low" priority issues based on definitions.

Discuss milestone with Jackie and if you need help determining what to drop and how to communicate (potentially) to issue requestors.

#### 1. Lifecycle Marketing - Current Milestone

Minimize the "Low" and "Medium" columns. Your focus should first be on the "Top" and "High" priority issues.

Prioritize completion of "Top" priority issues, then "High" priority issues.

Labels

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Prioritization labels

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

DG-Priority::Top: Immediate action needed, aligned to OKRs. This category will be limited because not everything can be a priority. Timeframe: Immediate action needed.

DG-Priority::High: Not requiring immediate action, but aligned to OKRs, intelligent nurture, or free user journey. Timeframe: Within weeks.

DG-Priority::Med: Requests submitted that align to OKRs, intelligent nurture, or free user journey. Process improvements to fix broken processes, or improve lifecycle marketing team efficiency. Timeframe: Within months.

DG-Priority::Low: Requests submitted that would be helpful, but can be pushed for higher priority issues. Nice-to-have improvements for lifecycle marketing team processes. Timeframe: No specific timeline.

DG-Priority::ToBePrioritized: Requests that have not yet been prioritized by the team.

Team labels

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

mktg-demandgen: DRI is in Demand Gen team

dg-lifecycle: DRI is in Lifecycle Marketing

dg-campaigns: DRI is in Campaigns Team

dg-request: Issue requesting Lifecycle Marketing support (did not originate from DRI team)

## Status labels

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

mktg-status::blocked: there were insufficient details in the issue for work to be completed  
mktg-status::wip: the issue is assigned and moved into appropriate time-based milestone  
mktg-status::plan: this is used for work that is in an earlier stage of planning and a specific request has not been made

This will likely be used mainly by campaign managers on issues that are not high priority but there is a desire to capture the idea/notes.

## Issue Templates

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

We ask that teams request work using the following issue templates in the campaigns project. These templates more clearly indicate what information and details are required in order for the request to be triaged.

Note on timelines: The campaigns team is focused on campaign strategy, execution, and optimization. Team member milestones focus on work to drive MQLs and SAOs, and requests will be committed to as bandwidth permits at discretion of Campaign Team Manager.

## Request Issue Templates

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Below are the issue templates to make a lifecycle request. For processes, please see our processes handbook page.

lifecycle-add-to-nurture  
request-email-followup  
request-email-invitation  
request-email-newsletter  
request-email-reminder  
request-email - only for general email requests For customer communications, please work with Marketing Ops.  
idea-campaign  
request-corp-conference-email

## Campaign Team Issue Templates

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The following issue templates are used by the campaigns team to organize their work, with appropriate labels applied for project management.

campaign-manager-wip  
to be used by Campaign Managers ONLY for simpler project management for their own initiated issues  
puts straight in WIP status with pre-set for current milestone and assignment to the person opening the issue  
lifecycle-marketing-freeuser-plan  
lifecycle-milestoneplan  
lifecycle-monthly-update

lifecycle-onboarding  
lifecycle-ooo  
lifecycle-reporting  
lifecycle-abtest

campaigns-mural  
campaigns-pathfactory-track  
campaigns-pf-buyer-journey  
campaigns-sdr-enablement

Fundamental principles of issue requests  
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The following issue templates are used by the campaigns team to organize their work, with appropriate labels applied for project management.

/assign @ - issues should have only DRI based on who will complete the work in the issue. If work needs to be completed by multiple people, consider breaking into separate issues with clear deliverables and due dates. (example: /assign @aklatzkin)  
/due 2021- - add due date based on workback schedules (example: /due 2020-07-13 or /due tomorrow or /due 07/13/2020)  
/milestone % - add milestone based on the due date of the issue (example: /milestone %"Mktg: )  
/weight - add weight between 1-5, with 1 being easiest (between 1-4 hours of time) and 5 being most complex (a full week of work). The majority of issues should fall into 1-2. If estimation is weight of 3+, break into separate issues for more manageable pieces to fit into milestones. (example: /weight 1)  
/epic - add epic of the overarching campaign or project to keep things organized. In almost all cases, there is a larger initiative that the issue relates to, so it is best practice to associate issues to the most relevant epic for visibility. (example: /epic <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-com/marketing/-/epics/370>)

Intake process daily/weekly steps  
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Team manager completes daily review of lifecycle marketing issues in triage assessing the following standards:

Are all details in the Submitter Checklist sufficiently complete in order to begin work?  
if yes, check that due date is at least 5 business days from date submitter details provided, move to mktg-status::wip, assign based on triage diagram, and put in current milestone (to be adjusted as needed by assignee)  
if no, comment to requester and move to mktg-status::blocked  
Does the request align to OKRs and key projects?  
if no, consider realistic timeline given priorities (and share with requester in comments, set up time to discuss if needed)

Shortcut issue comments for project management  
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

When a team member is picking up an issue from the backlog:

text  
/label ~"mktg-status::wip"  
/assign @  
/milestone %Mktg:2023-

This will change the status to wip (work in progress), allow quick assignment and add to the appropriate milestone.

## Key Resources

Overall Epic for Lifecycle Marketing  
FY25 Trial  
FY25 Persona Nurture  
FY25 Email Template Work  
Email UTM generator  
Nurture documentation

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## SECTION: marketing/lifecycle-marketing/email-best-practices.md

## Overview

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

This page focuses on email best practices and their implementation at GitLab. You'll also find information on important metrics to consider when sending an email and our email templates with image size guidelines.

## Email marketing best practices

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Please see our most up to date email best practices in our guide [here](#).

## Subject line best practices (and preview text)

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Use subject lines to justify sending the email and connecting to a problem that the reader might have

Ask yourself "why would I open this email"? - include the value proposition

Keep it short and sweet - only include that is absolutely necessary

Try to keep it under 65 characters

Front-load - put important information first

Be specific - emphasize what the reader "gets" out of reading this email

Test when you can!

Chad White, email marketing strategist and book author created the CUE-DIVE method:

- Contextual - personalized, localized, segmented, relevant, anticipated
- Urgent - topical, events, deadlines, newsjacking
- Emotional - aspirations, happiness, anxiety, duty, fear
- Detailed - answers the question "what is this email about?"

- Intriguing - questions, curiosity, mysterious, humor, puns
- Visual - very long or very short, unusual spelling, emoji, unusual punctuation
- Earned - testimonials, reviews, endorsements, media coverage

**SUBJECT LINES AFFECT OTHER METRICS TOO!** Subject lines affect click through rates & conversions! Poor subject lines can damage the performance of future email campaigns. Do not underestimate their importance!

The preview text is the first sentence displayed in an email client alone